

ESTHER ADENUGA

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Computational Semantics and Pragmatics
- Multilingual Natural Language Processing (NLP)
- NLP for Low-Resource Languages
- Language Documentation and Preservation
- Computer-Assisted Language Learning

EDUCATION

- **B.A. Linguistics/French (Combined Honors)** Jun. 2023
University of Ibadan Ibadan, Oyo, Nigeria
 - **Thesis:** Machine Learning Approach to Yoruba Named Entity Recognition
 - **Advisor:** Dr. Clement Odoje

PUBLICATIONS

- Odunayo Ogundepo, Akintunde Oladipo, Kelechi Ogueji, **Esther Adenuga**, David Ifeoluwa Adelani, and Jimmy Lin. (2025). **Improving Multilingual Math Reasoning for African Languages**. arxiv.org/abs/2505.19848. (preprint).
- Tyler A. Chang, Catherine Arnett., et al. (2025). **Global PIQA: Evaluating Physical Commonsense Reasoning Across 100+ Languages and Cultures**. arxiv.org/abs/2510.24081. (One of 335 authors)

PRESENTATIONS

- **Esther Adenuga**, Akintunde Oladipo, Odunayo Ogundepo, Ismail Daud, Deborah Popoola, Adeyemi Praise, Okechukwu God'spraise, Olasoji Akindejoye, Abolade Daud, Raphael Afolayan, Sharon Ibejih, Cynthia Amol (2025). **Physical Commonsense Reasoning for West African Languages**. *Multilingual Representation Learning (MRL) Workshop, EMNLP*, November 2025, Virtual (poster).

RESEARCH EXPERIENCES

- **NLP Research Fellow** Mar. 2025 - present
The African Research Collective (TARESCo), Lagos, Nigeria 
 - Led TARESCo's submission to the [MRL 2025 Shared Task](#): developed the dataset creation guide, coordinated annotators, and co-authored the accompanying paper.
 - Conduct linguistic data annotation, model evaluation, and dataset design for multiple projects advancing NLP for African languages.
 - Contribute to research writing, experiment design, and preparation of manuscripts for publication.
- **Phonetics Intern** Jul. 2023 - Aug. 2023
Living Tongues Institute for Endangered Languages, Salem, Oregon, USA 
 - Collaborated with a team under Dr. Gregory Anderson to conduct phonetic annotation and analysis of Mundari language speech samples using Praat.
 - Participated in weekly meetings to review annotation progress and share findings on environmental sound patterns and their changes.
- **Research Volunteer** Apr. 2020 - Nov. 2020
Tai Solarin University of Education, Ogun, Nigeria
 - Assisted two postgraduate students in sourcing resources on Orientalism and Classical Mythology.
 - Conducted literature reviews on the topics.
 - Synthesized research findings to support research objectives.
 - Edited and proofread thesis drafts, ensuring adherence to MLA formatting style.

TEACHING EXPERIENCES

- **Online English Tutor** Jan. 2024 - Apr. 2025
Enrydvyne Educational Services, UK 
 - Provided one-on-one tutoring to 15+ GCSE and A-level students in English Language and Literature.
 - Prepared and submitted detailed daily and weekly progress reports on students' performance to stakeholders.
- **Teacher** Sept. 2024 - Mar. 2025
Apostolic Faith Elementary School, Lagos, Nigeria
 - Instructed 3rd and 4th grade pupils in Literacy and French using Montessori and digital learning techniques.
- **Teacher** Aug. 2023 - Aug. 2024
Zion Pilgrims Christ School, Bauchi, Nigeria
 - Taught Literature-in-English to grades 7-12 and French to 80+ elementary students, improving average performance from 50% to 70%.
 - Served on prefectship and Christmas event committees.

LEADERSHIP AND VOLUNTEERING EXPERIENCES

- **Reviewer**

2025 Naija Voices Language Heritage Micro-Grants [🌐]

◦ Reviewed proposals supporting African language preservation, assessing project clarity, feasibility, and impact using a standardized evaluation rubric.

Jun. 2025
- **Contributor**

Google Crowdsource, University of Ibadan Chapter, Oyo State, Nigeria

◦ Contributed to data labeling and validation for improved AI datasets.

Dec. 2022 - Dec. 2024
- **Social Media Manager/Content Creator**

Publicity and Editorial CDS, National Youth Service Corps (NYSC), Bauchi State, Nigeria

◦ Managed the NYSC Bauchi Facebook page, covering events such as orphanage visits and community sensitization programs.

◦ Served as Advertising Manager for a 10-member team that produced the Bauchi State NYSC Magazine (Batch B, Stream 1 & 2, 2023).

Jan. 2024 - June. 2024
- **District General Secretary**

Apostolic Faith Campus Fellowship, Oyo State, Nigeria

◦ Coordinated secretaries from six tertiary institutions in Oyo State, collating and submitting reports to the national office.

◦ Organized events and programs in collaboration with the state president and outreach secretary.

Jan. 2022 - Jan. 2023

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT AND CERTIFICATES

- World Quant Applied Data Science Lab, WorldQuant University.

◦ ChatGPT Prompt Engineering for Developers, DeepLearning.AI

◦ Linguistic Prompt Design Training, RWS

◦ 120-Hour Teach English as a Foreign Language(TEFL) Certificate, Teacher Record

◦ Crash Course on Python, Coursera

◦ Introduction to Natural Language Processing, Analytics Vidhya

◦ Introduction to Programming using Python, Analytics Vidhya

In Progress

2025

2024

2024

2023

2022

2022

SKILLS

- **Technical:** Python, Praat, ELAN, Lexique Pro, L^AT_EX
- **Other Tools & Technologies:** Git, Github, MS Office Suite, Linux
- **Languages:** English (Fluent), Yoruba (Native), French (Basic), American Sign Language (Conversational)